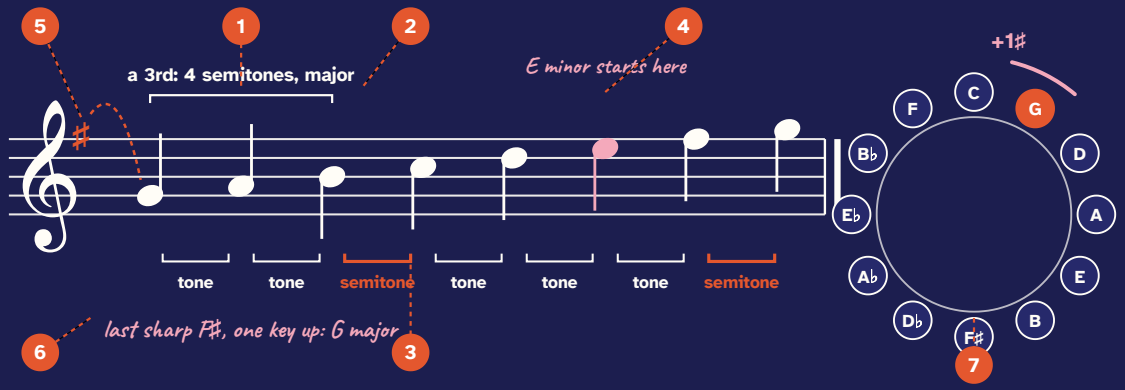
PART III · THE GROUND UNDER THE CHORDS

Scales and keys

Notes travel in families. Measure the distance between two notes, build the scales that whole pieces are made from, then learn to read the key a piece lives in. All of it is in one scale.



1 **Counting intervals** p. 51
count the letters, both ends included: G A B is a 3rd

2 **Major, minor and perfect** p. 53
the same number can be bigger or smaller: count the semitones

3 **Major scales** p. 55
tone, tone, semitone, tone, tone, tone, semitone

4 **Minor scales** p. 57
the same notes from the 6th note; the 7th often raised

5 **Keys and key signatures** p. 59
the sharps at the start apply all the way through

6 **Finding the key** p. 61
last sharp, one key up; second-last flat

7 **The circle of fifths** p. 63
clockwise, one more sharp each step

★ **Tips: when a note sounds wrong** p. 65